for her selfish purpose. This effort will continue in future and we in India have no doubt in our minds that if the integrity of the British Empire is left untouched at the end of the present war, a defeated Great Britain will once again threaten the peace of the world after a decade or two.

It is for the Axis Powers to consider whether they should now treat Great Britain in the same manner in which she treated the Austro-Hungarian and Ottoman Empires in 1918-19. If Great Britain is to be paid back in her own coin, then the British Empire will have to be broken up completely and the countries that are now under the British yoke will have to be set free. It should be remembered in this connection that even if India alone is left with Great Britain and the other parts of the Empire are dismembered, Great Britain with the assistance of the potential resources of India, will be in a position to challenge the New Order after some years.

Future peace in Europe at the end of this war demands imperatively a New Order, not only in Europe and Africa, but throughout the world. And with this New Order, the question of India is inseparably connected.

II. *Future of the British Empire as considered by us*

Even before the present war began, we in India were definitely of opinion that the British Empire was decadent. This was not the result of a theoretical knowledge of the laws operating in the history of mankind, but was the conclusion we reached after an observation of indisputable facts. The Empire had given the British people untold wealth and immeasurable resources but it had also given them comfort and luxury, self-complacency and arrogance. Consequently, deterioration in character and morale followed. One aspect of this deterioration is bankruptcy in diplomacy and statesmenship. The British we find in India and in Great Britain today are not the British we would find fifty years ago.

While on the one hand the British people have been deteriorating during the last few decades, there has been a phenomenal awakening among the suppressed nations of the Empire and particularly in India. The process of deterioration is thus being expedited by the pressures coming from different parts of the British Empire e.g. Ireland (Eire), South Africa, Palestine, India etc. owing to this national awakening everywhere.